

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of experience in enterprise security operations, working across Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) platforms within large, complex environments. I have deep expertise in monitoring, investigating, and responding to cyber security alerts and incidents across global infrastructure, drawing on hands-on experience with Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon, and Microsoft Defender. I lead threat hunting and threat modelling exercises aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, and I manage vulnerability remediation and penetration testing activities using industry-leading tooling. I am passionate about driving security best practice and embedding security-by-design principles across infrastructure and change programmes. I bring strong stakeholder communication skills and the ability to work both independently and collaboratively within cross-functional security teams.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection:** Microsoft Sentinel (Kusto Query Language (KQL)), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation Security Information and Event Management (NG-SIEM), alert triage, detection engineering, playbook development
- **EDR / XDR and Threat Hunting:** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent/Insight/Discover, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), proactive threat hunting, threat modelling, MITRE ATT&CK framework alignment
- **Incident Response:** End-to-end incident lifecycle management, National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) 800-61 methodology, digital forensics triage, escalation and post-incident review
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; vulnerability remediation, penetration test oversight and finding remediation
- **Identity and Access:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory (Azure AD)), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust
- **Security Operations and Automation:** Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR), Microsoft Sentinel playbooks, PowerShell scripting, Tanium endpoint management
- **Frameworks and Compliance:** NIST Cyber Security Framework (CSF), Center for Internet Security (CIS) Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Collaboration and Guidance:** Security-by-design advisory, change programme security reviews, third-party security partner management, security awareness training

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Monitor, investigate, and respond to cyber security alerts and incidents across an 8,000-user enterprise environment, using Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL) and CrowdStrike Falcon Extended Detection and Response (XDR) as primary platforms.
- Lead incident response activities aligned to the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) 800-61 framework, coordinating technical triage, containment, eradication, and post-incident review across infrastructure and business teams.
- Conduct structured threat hunting and threat modelling exercises mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, proactively identifying adversarial Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (TTPs) across endpoint, identity, and cloud environments.
- Manage vulnerability remediation and penetration testing activities using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), coordinating remediation workflows with infrastructure and application teams.

- Support and improve Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) tooling by engineering new detection rules, refining alert logic, and reducing false positive rates.
- Provide security guidance across infrastructure and change projects, driving security-by-design principles and ensuring security requirements are embedded early in project lifecycles.
- Maintain and continuously improve cyber security operational documentation, incident playbooks, and SOAR automation workflows, supporting repeatable and scalable security operations.
- Oversee Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and Conditional Access policies within Microsoft Entra ID, enforcing least-privilege access across the organisation.
- Administer mobile device security via Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) across the end-user estate.
- Work closely with internal IT teams and third-party security partners to coordinate security responses, share threat intelligence, and mature the organisation's overall cyber resilience posture.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Monitored and triaged security alerts using Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, escalating confirmed incidents through established response procedures and contributing to the development of detection content and alert playbooks.
- Supported threat hunting operations and threat modelling activities, utilising MITRE ATT&CK to map emerging adversary behaviours to existing detection coverage and identify gaps requiring new detection engineering.
- Led vulnerability scanning programmes across on-premises and cloud infrastructure using Tenable.io and Nessus, generating remediation reports and tracking remediation progress with asset owners.
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access policies, MFA, and Single Sign-On (SSO) integrations, ensuring identity governance aligned to organisational security policy.
- Configured and managed Mimecast email security platform, tuning policies to reduce phishing exposure and improving email gateway alerting coverage.
- Contributed to the development of security awareness training and phishing simulation programmes, improving end-user security culture across the institution.
- Supported Check Point Harmony firewall operations, managing rule sets and reviewing logs for suspicious activity indicative of network-based threats.
- Assisted with PAM onboarding and policy configuration within BeyondTrust, supporting the extension of privileged access controls across critical systems.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Delivered security engineering and infrastructure support across a Software as a Service (SaaS) and Financial Technology (FinTech) environment, implementing security controls aligned to compliance requirements.
- Managed endpoint protection, patching, and security monitoring for the corporate environment, ensuring consistent security posture across the user estate.
- Supported identity and access management, including configuration of Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and access review processes to enforce least-privilege principles.
- Conducted internal vulnerability assessments and assisted with remediation tracking, contributing to a structured vulnerability management lifecycle.
- Collaborated with development and quality teams to embed security controls into release and infrastructure change processes, promoting security-by-design across the engineering function.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and operationalised Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender across an 8,000-user estate, significantly improving threat visibility and XDR coverage.

- Engineered a suite of custom detection rules and SOAR automation playbooks within Microsoft Sentinel, reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR) for high-fidelity security alerts.
- Designed and implemented Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to continuously validate detection and response controls, providing measurable evidence of security posture improvement.
- Extended BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) coverage to critical administrative accounts, reducing lateral movement risk and strengthening the organisation's identity security baseline.
- Led threat hunting campaigns aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, identifying previously undetected adversarial activity and converting findings into permanent detection rules within Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)